

Białowieża Forest

Białowieża is lowland Europe's only old-growth, or "primeval," forest. Forests like this once covered all of northeastern Europe. Its many different trees and habitats mean Białowieża is home to thousands of animals, including the rare European bison!



All domestic dogs are descended from the gray wolf.

Gray wolf

The gray wolf is found in Europe, North America, and Asia. Packs of four to five wolves hunt deer, elk, wild boar, rabbits, and beavers.



Common toad

Many parts of this forest are wet, including rare places known as "spruce bog forests," where coniferous spruce trees grow in very wet ground. These habitats make a perfect home for the common toad!

Pine marten Pine martens are related to weasels but, unlike weasels, they hunt in the trees. They chase small mammals such as squirrels.

Red fox Foxes feed on a wide variety of foods. In Białowieża, they eat yellow-necked mice, hares, and the carcasses of red deer killed by wolves or lynxes.

Red deer Red deer find leaves, small twigs, and bark to eat in the fall and winter, and herbs and grasses during the summer.

A male and female red fox have a territory that they share, which is where they raise their young.